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Security schema for secure device onboarding

Abstract

Presented herein are a system and secure device onboarding techniques. A Connectivity Management Platform (CMP) receives a request for an access token that includes a user identifier, a customer organization identifier, and an authorization code from a Device Management Platform (DMP), verifies the authorization code, queries an enterprise server using the user identifier and the customer organization identifier to confirm the user belongs to the customer organization, generates the access token, stores the access token in an authentication datastore, and transmits the access token to DMP. The CMP receives a provisioning request including an eSIM identifier of a device and an access token from the DMP, verifies the access token, obtains a customer organization identifier based thereon, queries an enterprise server using the eSIM identifier and the customer organization identifier to confirm the device belongs to the customer organization, and facilitates secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present application relates to a system and techniques involving network equipment and services.

BACKGROUND

(2) Networking architectures have grown increasingly complex in communication environments. In

particular, mobile communication networks have grown substantially as end users become increasingly connected to mobile network environments. As the number of mobile users increases, efficient management of communication resources and of users becomes more critical.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a flowchart depicting an example secure device onboarding flow.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram depicting a system and corresponding communication flows between components of the system, according to an example embodiment.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a communication flow diagram depicting a user authentication process, according to an example embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a communication flow diagram depicting a device provisioning process, according to an example embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a flowchart depicting an example method for implementing a user authentication process, according to an example embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a flowchart depicting an example method for implementing a device provisioning process, according to an example embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 7 depicts a hardware block diagram of a computing device that may perform functions associated with operations discussed herein in connection with the techniques depicted in FIGS. 2-6.

DESCRIPTION OF EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS

- (8) Overview
- (9) Presented herein are techniques to provide a security schema for secure device onboarding that enables trust between wireless devices and enterprises and customers, to ensure that the wireless devices cannot be operationalized by other entities (such as other enterprises, customers, or rogue actors that do not own the devices). The security schema can be implemented for organizations (e.g., companies or other enterprises) to securely configure data with a provisioning entity through intermediate device management platforms. If implemented by a Connectivity Management Platform (CMP) and a Device Management Platform (DMP), the secure device onboarding (SDO) security schema described herein can ensure a secure mechanism for a customer organization to configure network settings of a DMP-provided electronic or embedded Subscriber Identity Module (eSIM) (e.g., of a wireless device) on the CMP.
- (10) “Connectivity Management Platform” (CMP) refers to a platform used for deploying and scaling or otherwise managing wireless devices with a managed cellular connectivity service.
- (11) “Device Management Platform” (DMP) refers to a software platform used to configure, manage, monitor, and automate a large deployment of wireless devices/networks.
- (12) “Customer Organization” (CO) refers to an organization which purchases services of the DMP and the CMP and owns the wireless devices and their eSIMs (e.g., companies or other enterprises).
- (13) “Customer” refers to an administrator or other user from the customer organization who uses the DMP.
- (14) “Secure Device Onboarding” (SDO) refers to a service used to automate the provisioning process for wireless devices with eSIMs, such as gateways, routers, Internet of Things (IoT) devices, smart phones, and/or any other cellular-capable wireless devices, to establish connectivity to one or more mobile carriers.
- (15) Any secrets, keys, or tokens generated by the system and methods described herein may be any secrets/keys or tokens that are generated to be specific to each customer organization. This ensures that the customer (user) that is using the service on the DMP is authenticated, and part of the security chain created for the customer organization. The system and methods described herein

help to reduce the risk posed by compromised or mismanaged secrets/keys to avoid exposing multiple devices across multiple organizations. Thus, compromise of one organization's secret key or token does not affect other organizations and their devices, nor compromise the entire DMP.

Example Embodiments

(16) Generally, Secure Device Onboarding provides a mechanism for platforms managed using device management software to onboard a device onto a customer's network carrier account without manual intervention required to configure different network settings, such as Access Point Names (APNs)/Data Network Names (DNNs) and static Internet Protocol (IP) addresses. This enables devices to be onboarded to a network without minimal technical expertise and ensures or reduces the possibility for errors during configuration.

(17) An example Secure Device Onboarding (SDO) flow **100** is shown in FIG. **1** illustrating example details for a one-time setup process whereby a customer organization can configure a Device Management Platform (DMP) with a network provider choice, communication, rate plans, and APNs. The example SDO flow **100** of FIG. **1** may include the following steps: (1) ordering a cellular gateway (step **110**); (2) Receiving and unpacking the gateway (step **120**); (3) Day 0—powering on and provisioning cellular service (step **130**); (4) communicating, by the Device Management Platform, customer preferences to SDO services of a Connectivity Management Platform (step **140**); (5) providing, by the SDO services of the Connectivity Management Platform, automated zero touch device provisioning (step **150**); and (6) providing ongoing operations visibility (Day N) and reduced connectivity total cost of ownership (step **160**).

(18) However, the example SDO flow **100** of FIG. **1** may not be secured across entities such as the customer/user, the customer organization, the Device Management Platform, and the Connectivity Management Platform. Secrets/keys can be used to secure communications and/or interactions among such entities; however, if the secrets/keys are compromised or mismanaged, potential security risks could be exposed for devices across multiple organizations. Further, trust between the enterprise and the device may not be established through the example SDO flow **100** of FIG. **1**, which risks the authenticity of the device. If the device is compromised (e.g., using its serial number and its secret key), any other rogue actor may be able to claim the device and its ownership. The system and techniques according to example embodiments described herein address the above issues, among other improvements and enhancements to the SDO process.

(19) FIG. **2** is a block diagram depicting a system **200** and corresponding communication flows between components of the system **200**, according to an example embodiment. As shown in FIG. **2**, system **200** includes an authorization server **205**, a Device Management Platform (DMP) **210**, a Connectivity Management Platform (CMP) **220**, and an enterprise server **250**. The CMP **220** provides Secure Device Onboarding (SDO) services **230**. Enterprise server **250** may include an Account Management database (DB) **252** and an eSIM Inventory database (DB) **256**. Although only one enterprise server **250** is shown in FIG. **2**, there may be multiple distinct enterprise servers and/or multiple separate databases dedicated to each respective functionality described herein.

(20) As further described below, the CMP **220** (and/or services provided via the SDO services **230**) may include Identity services **232**, a Customer Organization Resolution service **234**, Provisioning services **236**, and an eSIM Ownership service **238**. The CMP **220** (and/or the SDO services **230**) may also include an Authentication Datastore **235** in communication with the Identity services **232** and the Provisioning services **236** that is configured to store access tokens in connection with identifiers and/or other information relating to authorized users and customer organizations.

(21) FIG. **2** also depicts a user **201** and a wireless device **202**, which may be in communication with the provisioning services **236** of CMP of system **200** (e.g., via a radio access network (RAN), not shown in FIG. **2**). In FIG. **2**, it is assumed that the user **201** is an administrator or the like that may be part of the customer organization that has acquired licenses of the DMP **210** to manage their wireless device **202** (and/or any other wireless devices **202A-202N**) and support with Day-0 configuration of the wireless device **202**. User **201** may be referred to herein generally as a

“customer” that is part of/belongs to the customer organization. Wireless device **202** may be any wireless device that utilizes an eSIM to facilitate cellular connectivity with one or more cellular networks. In various embodiments, wireless device **202** may be a gateway, a router, an Internet of Things (IoT) device, a cellular phone or device, etc., that can be configured (e.g., via an eSIM profile) to connect to a cellular network provider. Services offered in SDO services **230** can be categorized into two categories: (1) identity services, and (2) provisioning services. For case of explanation, some example embodiments described herein involve the customer/user **201** initiating secure device provisioning operations for the wireless device **202** (and/or its corresponding eSIM). However, it should be appreciated that the techniques described herein can be applied, and may be especially beneficial for, securely managing device provisioning operations of a plurality of devices **202A-202N** with respective eSIMs (e.g., improvements for simultaneously managing a large population of IoT devices), as shown in FIG. 2.

(22) Generally, an eSIM profile refers to software that is downloaded to an eSIM-enabled device to access a carrier's mobile network. An eSIM profile is a virtual profile that stores a user's subscription and network settings, and may include an Integrated Circuit Card Identifier (ICCID), an International Mobile Subscriber Identity (IMSI) or Subscription Permanent Identifier (SUPI), a Mobile Station Integrated Services Digital Network (MSISDN) number (e.g., phone number), security algorithms, authentication/security keys, etc. for a wireless device/wireless connections, network identifying information, such as one or more Public Land Mobile Network (PLMN) identifiers, APN/DNN information, operating frequencies, etc. and/or any other information that can be defined according to Third Generation Partnership Project (3GPP) and or Global System for Mobile Communications Association (GSMA) standards. The ICCID may be a globally unique serial number that identifies the embedded SIM (IC chip) itself and cannot be changed. The IMSI or SUPI may be a number that uniquely identifies each user of a cellular network (e.g., GSM mobile phone subscriber identifier), and may be changed/updated for the eSIM. While an eSIM only has one ICCID assigned thereto, in some embodiments, an eSIM may have numerous eSIM profiles (e.g., different IMSIs, different MSISDNs, etc.) from different carriers for accessing different mobile networks. However, only one eSIM profile (e.g., one IMSI, one MSISDN, etc.) will be active on a device at any given time. In some embodiments, an eSIM profile may include enterprise specific information, such as a user identifier/user credentials for an enterprise, badge number, department/group/class/tier or other role information (e.g., management, engineering, gold service, bronze service, etc.), and/or the like.

(23) Generally, the DMP **210** can interface with the authorization server **205** and the CMP **220**, which may further interface with enterprise server **250** via a DMP Account Management Application Programming Interface (API) **242** and a DMP eSIM Inventory API **246**. The CMP **220** may also interface with the authorization server **205**. In at least one embodiment, the DMP Account Management API **242** and the DMP eSIM Inventory API **246** may be implemented via the DMP **210**, although the APIs are illustrated external to the DMP **210** for FIG. 2 for purposes of brevity only. Thus, DMP **210** may also interface with enterprise server **250**.

(24) Broadly during operation of embodiments herein, the Identity services **232** of CMP **220** (one of the SDO services **230**) authenticates and authorizes the user **201** (e.g., the consumer of the services) by authenticating an identifier of the customer/user (e.g., a user name or other user ID) using the authorization server **205** (e.g., an Identity and Access Management (IAM) System, such as an OAuth2.0 Authorization Server with Open ID Connect based authentication), and provides an access token (also referred to herein as an “SDO access token”) that may be considered an authentication token that can be used for authenticating to the Provisioning services **236** of CMP **220**. According to one aspect, the request for the access token may also involve an identifier that uniquely identifies the customer organization (also referred to herein as a customer organization identifier, or “COID”) to be sent by the DMP **210** along with the identifier of the user (e.g., user name/ID). The Identity services **232** performs a look-up using a Customer Organization Resolution

service **234** of the CMP **220** (of the SDO services **230**) to verify that the user **201** actually belongs to the customer organization.

(25) According to one aspect, the Identity services **232** of CMP **220** may comprise an authentication token generator/logic (or secret key generator/logic) that is configured to generate the access token, or SDO access token. More specifically, the SDO access token may be a secret key that is created to be specific to the user associated with the user name/ID, specific to the customer organization that is associated with the COID, or specific to both the user and the customer organization. In some examples, the SDO access token may be a pseudo-randomly generated authentication token for each customer/user and customer organization. In other examples, the SDO access token may be generated based on the identifier for the user (e.g., user name/ID), the identifier for the customer organization (COID), or a combination thereof. In some examples, the SDO access token may be generated based on the user identifier and/or the customer organization identifier using one or more cryptographic transformation techniques (e.g., XOR, encryption, hashing, salting, etc.) to combine the respective identifiers together and create the SDO access token to uniquely identify a respective user/customer organization pair in the CMP **220**, while also obfuscating the underlying user identifier and customer organization identifier for enhanced security. Various other known techniques for generating authentication tokens and secret keys are also possible. Additionally, or alternatively, various other data or information may be used to generate an SDO access token for utilization in the techniques described herein.

(26) The Provisioning services **236** of CMP **220** (another one of the SDO services **230**) may provide application programming interfaces (APIs) to configure the eSIM of the device **202** (and/or one or more eSIMs of one or more devices **202A-202N**) in the network. According to one aspect, the device provisioning request may also involve an identifier that uniquely identifies an eSIM of the device **202** (also referred to herein as an eSIM identifier, or “EID”) (and/or eSIM identifiers that uniquely identify respective eSIMs of each of the devices **202A-202N**) to be sent by the DMP **210** along with the SDO access token provided by the Identity services **232** of CMP **220**. For each eSIM/device transaction, the Provisioning services **236** performs a look-up using an eSIM Ownership service **238** of the CMP **220** (of the SDO services **230**) to ensure that the device provisioning request is being invoked against an eSIM/device **202** (and/or one or more eSIMs/devices **202A-202N**) that actually belongs to the customer organization.

(27) According to one aspect, the eSIM identifier (or “EID”) may be associated with an Internet of Things (IoT) device that includes (i.e., has installed or inserted therein) an eSIM provided by the DMP **210** and is owned by the respective customer organization. In some embodiments, the EID may be the unique identifier for the eSIM (IC chip) itself (e.g., an Integrated Circuit Card Identifier, also referred to as the ICCID of the eSIM), for example. The device provisioning process described herein provides a secure mechanism for the user/customer organization to onboard the IoT device (or other wireless device) to a network, and automatically configure the DMP-provided eSIM of the IoT device with various network settings via device provisioning operations.

(28) As the user **201** (customer) and the customer organization (CO) are managed by the DMP **210**, two application programming interfaces (APIs) can be implemented by the DMP **210** to ensure that the SDO services **230** (e.g., Identity services **232** and Provisioning services **236**) of the CMP **220** can establish the trust relationships: (1) a DMP Account Management API **242**, and (2) a DMP eSIM Inventory API **246**.

(29) The DMP Account Management API **242** may be used to establish a trust relationship between the user **201** (customer), the customer organization (CO), the DMP **210**, and the CMP **220**. The identifier for the user **201**, such as a user name as resolved by the IAM system of authorization server **205**, and an identifier for the customer organization (COID) can be sent to the DMP Account Management API **242**, which responds back with a user status indicating whether the identifier for the user **201** (e.g., user name) belongs to the customer organization corresponding to the COID or not. As further described below with reference to the user authentication process **300** of FIG. 3, the

Identity services **232** uses the Customer Organization Resolution service **234** to invoke the DMP Account Management API **242** to query an Account Management database **252** of an enterprise server **250** using the identifier for the user **201** (e.g., user name) and the identifier for the customer organization (COID).

(30) The DMP eSIM Inventory API **246** may be used to establish a trust relationship between the eSIM of the device **202** (and/or one or more eSIMs/devices **202A-202N**) and the customer organization (CO). The customer organization identifier (COID) and an eSIM identifier (EID) for the device **202** (and/or the one or more devices **202A-202N**) can be sent to the DMP eSIM Inventory API **246**, which responds back with an eSIM/device status indicating whether the identifier for the eSIM (EID) of the device **202** (and/or identifiers for eSIMs of the one or more devices **202A-202N**) belongs to the customer organization corresponding to the COID or not. As further described below with reference to the device provisioning process **400** of FIG. 4, the Provisioning services **236** uses the eSIM Ownership service **238** to invoke the DMP eSIM Inventory API **246** to query an eSIM Inventory database **256** of an enterprise server **250** using the identifier for the eSIM (EID) and the identifier for the customer organization (COID).

(31) Customer (User) Authentication Flow:

(32) For establishing trust between the user **201** (customer), the customer organization (CO), the DMP **210** and the CMP **220**, an authorization server **205** (such as an OAuth2.0 Authorization Server with Open ID Connect based authentication) may be used, for example. The services exposed for SDO services **230** (e.g., Identity services **232** and Provisioning services **236**) may be registered as resources with the authorization server **205** associated with the customer organization. In the example of an OAuth2.0 Authorization Server, using Open ID Connect ensures that the user **201** is authenticated using the authorization server **205** on behalf of the customer organization.

(33) In the user authentication process **300** described below with reference to FIG. 3, the DMP **210** invokes the SDO services **230** (e.g., Identity services **232**) on behalf of the user **201** and passes along the customer organization identifier (COID) associated with the customer organization. The Identity services **232** uses the Customer Organization Resolution service **234** to query the Account Management database **252** of the enterprise server **250** (via the DMP Account Management API **242**) using the COID to verify if the user **201** belongs to the customer organization. As part of establishing trust between the user **201**, the customer organization, the DMP **210**, and the CMP **220**, the user authentication process **300** involves creating a secret key (also referred to herein as an “SDO access token”) that will be used for further transactions (e.g., for secure device provisioning as described herein, etc.).

(34) As shown in FIG. 3, the user authentication process **300** begins when DMP **210** transmits a message **302** that indicates an initial request for an SDO access token (“getAccessToken()”) to CMP **220**.

(35) Identity services **232** of CMP **220** receives the message **302** indicating the initial request for the SDO access token from the DMP **210** and returns a message **304** indicating a redirect to authorization server **205** back to the DMP **210**.

(36) DMP **210** receives the message **304** indicating the redirect to authorization server **205** from CMP **220** (Identity services **232**), and transmits a message **306** indicating an authorization request (e.g., an account login request), along with login credentials for the user **201** (e.g., user name, and password or other credentials for a user account) to authorization server **205** for verification.

(37) Authorization server **205** receives the message **306** indicating the authorization request from DMP **210**, verifies the credentials of the user **201**, and if the credentials are verified, returns a message **308** including an authorization code (“AuthCode”) and redirect to CMP **220** (Identity services **232**) back to DMP **210**. In various embodiments, the authorization code can be any alphanumeric code, string of characters, temporary PIN, etc. that can be utilized to verify authenticity of the user **201** (and/or the DMP **210**) by the CMP **220**, as discussed in further detail below.

- (38) DMP **210** receives the message **308** including the authorization code (AuthCode) and redirect from authorization server **205**, and transmits a message **310** indicating a subsequent request for the SDO access token (“getAccessToken()”), along with the identifier for the user **201** (e.g., user name), an identifier for a customer organization (COID), and the authorization code (AuthCode), to CMP **220**.
- (39) Identity services **232** of CMP **220** receives the message **310** indicating the subsequent request for the SDO access token with the identifier for the user **201** (e.g., user name), the identifier for the customer organization (COID), and the authorization code (AuthCode) from DMP **210**, and transmits a message **312** indicating a request to verify the authorization code (“verifyAuthCode”), along with the identifier for the user **201** (user name) and the authorization code (AuthCode), to authorization server **205**.
- (40) Authorization server **205** receives the message **312** indicating the verification request from CMP **220** (Identity services **232**), verifies the authorization code (AuthCode) associated with the identifier for the user **201** (e.g., user name), and if the authorization code (AuthCode) is verified, returns a message **314** indicating successful verification back to CMP **220**.
- (41) Identity services **232** of CMP **220** receives the message **314** indicating successful verification of the authorization code (AuthCode) for the user **201** from authorization server **205**, and uses the Customer Organization Resolution service **234** of the CMP **220** to transmit a message **316** indicating a query (“verifyCustomerOrganizationResolution()” with customer organization) along with the user identifier and the CO identifier to the enterprise server **250** (via DMP Account Management API **242**) to check if the identifier for the user **201** (e.g., user name) is associated with the identifier for the customer organization (COID) in the Account Management database **252** of the enterprise server **250**.
- (42) Enterprise server **250** receives the message **316** indicating the query, and including the identifier for the user **201** (e.g., user name) and the identifier for the customer organization (COID), from Identity services **232** (e.g., via Customer Organization Resolution service **234** of CMP **220** and DMP Account Management API **242**), checks the identifier for the user **201** (user name) against the Account Management database **252** for the customer organization based on the COID, and returns a message **318** indicating a user status regarding whether the identifier for the user **201** (user name) belongs to the customer organization associated with the COID back to the Identity services **232** (via DMP Account Management API **242** and Customer Organization Resolution service **234** of the CMP **220**).
- (43) Identity services **232** of CMP **220** receives the message **318** indicating the user status from the enterprise server **250** (via DMP Account Management API **242** and Customer Organization Resolution service **234** of CMP **220**), and generates the SDO access token if the user status indicates that the identifier for the user **201** (e.g., user name) belongs to the customer organization associated with the COID. Identity services **232** then transmits a message **320** indicating a request to store the SDO access token in the Authentication Datastore **235** of CMP **220**, along with the identifier for the user **201** (user name) and the identifier for the customer organization (COID). Identity services **232** of CMP **220** also transmits a message **322** including the SDO access token to DMP **210** in response to the message **310** indicating the subsequent request for the SDO access token.
- (44) At the end of the user authentication process **300** of FIG. 3, DMP **210** receives the message **322** including the SDO access token from CMP **220** (Identity services **232**), and locally stores the SDO access token for use in authenticating one or more device transactions (e.g., secure device provisioning, etc.).
- (45) As described herein, the SDO access token may be a secret key created by the Identity services **232** to be specific to the user **201** as well as to the respective customer organization (CO), which mitigates risk of a compromised secret key/token affecting other customers, organizations, or the DMP **210** itself.

(46) Thus, the user authentication process **300** of FIG. **3** establishes trust between the user **201** (customer), the customer organization (CO), the DMP **210**, and the CMP **220**. In some example implementations, the Customer Organization Resolution service **234** of CMP **220** and the DMP Account Management API **242** provided by DMP **210** enable the Identity services **232** of CMP **220** to establish this trust relationship.

(47) Device Provisioning Flow:

(48) For individual eSIM/device transactions, trust also needs to be established between the eSIM of device **202** (and/or eSIMs of devices **202A-202N**) and the customer organization (CO). This can be achieved in the device provisioning process **400** described below with reference to FIG. **4**, in which the Provisioning services **236** may use the SDO access token to obtain (e.g., retrieve or derive) the identifier for the customer organization (COID) by accessing the Authentication Datastore **235** of the CMP **220** (e.g., to verify the SDO access token and obtain the corresponding COID), and then using the eSIM Ownership service **238** to query the eSIM Inventory database **256** of the enterprise server **250** (via DMP eSIM Inventory API **246**) using the COID to verify if the device **202** (and/or the devices **202A-202N**) belongs to the customer organization. As part of establishing trust between the eSIM/device **202** and the customer organization, the device provisioning process **400** utilizes the secret key (the SDO access token) that was generated and stored during the user authentication process **300** of FIG. **3**.

(49) As shown in FIG. **4**, the device provisioning process **400** begins when the DMP **210** sends a message **402** that indicates a device provisioning request (“eSIMProvisioning()”), along with an identifier for an eSIM (EID) of a device **202** (and/or one or more devices **202A-202N** with eSIMs to be securely onboarded to a network) and the SDO access token, to CMP **220**.

(50) Provisioning services **236** of CMP **220** receives the message **402** indicating the device provisioning request, and including the identifier for the eSIM (EID) of the device **202** (and/or the devices **202A-202N**) and the SDO access token, from the DMP **210**, and sends a message **404** indicating a verification request (“verifySDOAccessToken”) and including the SDO access token to check the Authentication Datastore **235** of CMP **220** and verify the SDO access token (e.g., by confirming that a matching SDO access token is stored therein). If the Authentication Datastore **235** confirms that there is a match, then Authentication Datastore **235** returns a message **406** including the identifier for the customer organization (COID) that is associated with the SDO access token in the Authentication Datastore **235** back to Provisioning services **236**. In another variation, the Provisioning services **236** may be configured to derive the COID directly from the SDO access token itself after it is verified via the Authentication Datastore **235**.

(51) Provisioning services **236** receives the message **406** including the identifier for the customer organization (COID) that is associated with the SDO access token from the Authentication Datastore **235**, and uses the eSIM Ownership service **238** of the CMP **220** to transmit a message **408** indicating a query (“verifyESIMOwnership()” with customer organization) along with the eSIM identifier and the CO identifier to the enterprise server **250** (via DMP eSIM Inventory API **246**) to check if the identifier for the eSIM (EID) of the device **202** (and/or the one or more devices **202A-202N** with eSIMs) is associated with the customer organization corresponding to the COID in the eSIM Inventory database **256** of the enterprise server **250**.

(52) Enterprise server **250** receives the message **408** indicating the query, and including the identifier for the eSIM (EID) of the device **202** (and/or the one or more devices **202A-202N** with eSIMs) and the identifier for the customer organization (COID), from Provisioning services **236** (e.g., via eSIM Ownership service **238** of CMP **220** and DMP eSIM Inventory API **246**), and checks the identifier for the eSIM (EID) of the device **202** (and/or the one or more devices **202A-202N** with eSIMs) against the eSIM Inventory database **256** for the customer organization based on the COID. For example, eSIM mapping data stored in the eSIM Inventory database **256** may come from a manufacturing process or an invoicing process where eSIMs are distributed to a customer organization. Thus, a security mechanism is provided whereby each device provisioning call is

checked against the enterprise server **250** to ensure that the eSIM does indeed belong to the customer organization of the user from which the call is originating.

(53) If the enterprise server **250** determines that the EID is not associated with the COID in the eSIM Inventory database **256**, then the enterprise server **250** returns a message **410** indicating an eSIM/device status (failure) indicating that the device **202** associated with the eSIM identifier (EID) does not belong to the customer organization corresponding to the COID back to the Provisioning services **236** (via DMP eSIM Inventory API **246** and eSIM Ownership service **238**). In response to receiving the message **410** indicating the eSIM/device status of “failure” from the enterprise server **250**, the Provisioning services **236** of the CMP **220** sends a message **412** back to the DMP **210** indicating that the eSIM Provisioning request is denied, because the eSIM does not belong to the customer organization.

(54) If the enterprise server **250** determines that the EID is associated with the COID in the eSIM Inventory database **256**, then the enterprise server **250** returns a message **414** indicating an eSIM/device status (success) indicating that the device **202** associated with the eSIM identifier (EID) belongs to the customer organization corresponding to the COID back to the Provisioning services **236** (via DMP eSIM Inventory API **246** and eSIM Ownership service **238**). In response to receiving the message **414** indicating the eSIM/device status of “success” from the enterprise server **250**, the Provisioning services **236** of CMP **220** can determine that the eSIM corresponding to the EID, and hence the device **202** itself (and/or the one or more devices **202A-202N** with eSIMs), belongs to the customer organization associated with the COID, and then the Provisioning services **236** performs an eSIM provisioning action **416** for configuring an eSIM profile with respect to the device **202**. The eSIM provisioning action **416** may facilitate secure provisioning of the eSIM of the device **202** (and/or the one or more devices **202A-202N** with respective eSIMs) with an eSIM profile. For example, the eSIM provisioning action **416** may facilitate the downloading of a new eSIM profile onto the eSIM of the device **202** using any techniques now known in the art or hereinafter developed so that the eSIM can connect to a target radio access network.

(55) Once the eSIM provisioning action **416** has been completed (e.g., the eSIM profile has been configured for the eSIM of the device **202**), the Provisioning services **236** of the CMP **220** then transmits a message **418** indicating a result of the eSIM provisioning action **416** (e.g., eSIM provisioning complete) back to the DMP **210** in response to the message **402** indicating the device provisioning request. At the end of the device provisioning process **400** of FIG. 4, the DMP **210** receives the message **418** indicating the result of the eSIM provisioning action **416** from the CMP **220** (Provisioning services **236**), and can notify the user **201** that the eSIM provisioning request to configure the eSIM profile for the device **202** (and/or the one or more devices **202A-202N** with respective eSIMs) has been completed successfully.

(56) Since the SDO access token may be a secret key that is created by the Identity services **232** so as to be specific to the user **201** associated with the user identifier (e.g., user name) and/or to the respective customer organization associated with the COID, the Provisioning services **236** utilizing the SDO access token in connection with the device provisioning process **400** of FIG. 4 to securely onboard one or more devices **202** (e.g., a single IoT device or many IoT devices at the same time) onto a network and automatically configure the eSIM of the device **202** with various network settings mitigates the risk of a compromised secret key affecting devices of other customers or organizations, and prevents unauthorized users and enterprises from onboarding eSIMs/devices that they do not own.

(57) Thus, the device provisioning process **400** of FIG. 4 establishes trust between the eSIM of the device **202** (and/or devices **202A-202N** with respective eSIMs) and the customer organization (CO) for each individual eSIM/device transaction. In some example implementations, the eSIM Ownership service **238** of CMP **220** and the DMP eSIM Inventory API **246** provided by the DMP **210** enable the Provisioning services **236** of CMP **220** to establish this trust relationship.

(58) FIG. 5 is a flowchart depicting an example method **500** for implementing a user authentication process, according to an example embodiment.

(59) At step **510**, method **500** includes receiving, by a Connectivity Management Platform (CMP), a request for a secure device onboarding (SDO) access token from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the request includes an identifier for a user, an identifier of a customer organization, and an authorization code.

(60) At step **520**, method **500** includes verifying the authorization code via an authorization server.

(61) Upon verifying the authorization code, at step **530**, method **500** includes querying, by the CMP, an enterprise server using the identifier for the user and the identifier for the customer organization (COID) to confirm whether the user belongs to the customer organization.

(62) At step **540**, method **500** further includes, based on determining that the user belongs to the customer organization: generating, by the CMP, the SDO access token (step **542**); storing the SDO access token in an authentication datastore of the CMP (step **544**); and transmitting, by the CMP, the SDO access token to the DMP for use in one or more device transactions (step **546**).

(63) FIG. 6 is a flowchart depicting an example method **600** for implementing a device provisioning process, according to an example embodiment.

(64) At step **610**, method **600** includes receiving, by a Connectivity Management Platform (CMP), a device provisioning request from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the device provisioning request includes an identifier for an eSIM (EID) of a device and a secure device onboarding (SDO) access token.

(65) At step **620**, method **600** includes verifying the SDO access token using an authentication datastore of the CMP.

(66) Upon verifying the SDO access token, at step **630**, method **600** includes obtaining, by the CMP, an identifier of a customer organization (COID) based on the SDO access token from the authentication datastore of the CMP.

(67) At step **640**, method **600** includes querying, by the CMP, an enterprise server using the identifier for the eSIM (EID) of the device and the identifier for the customer organization (COID) to confirm whether the device belongs to the customer organization.

(68) At step **650**, method **600** further includes, based on determining that the device belongs to the customer organization, then facilitating, by the CMP, secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.

(69) The system and methods described above with reference to FIGS. 2-6 provide techniques to establish a security schema between a provider of eSIM management services and Device Management Platforms to provide a secure mechanism for users to onboard their eSIM devices (e.g., wireless devices). According to example embodiments, dual verification can be performed to verify that a user belongs to a particular customer organization (e.g., refer to FIGS. 2, 3, and 5), and further verify that a customer organization is allowed to use a particular eSIM (e.g., refer to FIGS. 2, 4, and 6). The principles of separation of duties and least privilege are used to ensure that compromise of a secret key or token does not affect the security of the devices both horizontally (a compromised key or token does not affect other organizations or customers) and/or vertically (a compromised key or token does not affect the entire DMP).

(70) Reference is now made to FIG. 7, which depicts a hardware block diagram of a computing device (or other device, e.g., networking device) **700** that may perform functions associated with operations discussed herein in connection with the techniques depicted in FIGS. 2-6. In various embodiments, a computing device or apparatus, such as computing device **700** or any combination of computing devices **700**, may be configured as any entity/entities as discussed for the techniques depicted in connection with FIGS. 2-6, in order to perform operations of the various techniques discussed herein.

(71) In at least one embodiment, the computing device **700** may be any apparatus that may include one or more processor(s) **702**, one or more memory element(s) **704**, storage **706**, a bus **708**, one or

more network processor unit(s) **710** interconnected with one or more network input/output (I/O) interface(s) **712**, one or more I/O interface(s) **714**, and control logic **720**. In various embodiments, instructions associated with logic for computing device **700** can overlap in any manner and are not limited to the specific allocation of instructions and/or operations described herein.

(72) In at least one embodiment, processor(s) **702** is/are at least one hardware processor configured to execute various tasks, operations and/or functions for computing device **700** as described herein according to software and/or instructions configured for computing device **700**. Processor(s) **702** (e.g., a hardware processor) can execute any type of instructions associated with data to achieve the operations detailed herein. In one example, processor(s) **702** can transform an element or an article (e.g., data, information) from one state or thing to another state or thing. Any of potential processing elements, microprocessors, digital signal processor, baseband signal processor, modem, PHY, controllers, systems, managers, logic, and/or machines described herein can be construed as being encompassed within the broad term 'processor'.

(73) In at least one embodiment, memory element(s) **704** and/or storage **706** is/are configured to store data, information, software, and/or instructions associated with computing device **700**, and/or logic configured for memory element(s) **704** and/or storage **706**. For example, any logic described herein (e.g., control logic **720**) can, in various embodiments, be stored for computing device **700** using any combination of memory element(s) **704** and/or storage **706**. Note that in some embodiments, storage **706** can be consolidated with memory element(s) **704** (or vice versa), or can overlap/exist in any other suitable manner.

(74) In at least one embodiment, bus **708** can be configured as an interface that enables one or more elements of computing device **700** to communicate in order to exchange information and/or data. Bus **708** can be implemented with any architecture designed for passing control, data and/or information between processors, memory elements/storage, peripheral devices, and/or any other hardware and/or software components that may be configured for computing device **700**. In at least one embodiment, bus **708** may be implemented as a fast kernel-hosted interconnect, potentially using shared memory between processes (e.g., logic), which can enable efficient communication paths between the processes.

(75) In various embodiments, network processor unit(s) **710** may enable communication between computing device **700** and other systems, entities, etc., via network I/O interface(s) **712** (wired and/or wireless) to facilitate operations discussed for various embodiments described herein. In various embodiments, network processor unit(s) **710** can be configured as a combination of hardware and/or software, such as one or more Ethernet driver(s) and/or controller(s) or interface cards, Fibre Channel (e.g., optical) driver(s) and/or controller(s), wireless receivers/transmitters/transceivers, baseband processor(s)/modem(s), and/or other similar network interface driver(s) and/or controller(s) now known or hereafter developed to enable communications between computing device **700** and other systems, entities, etc. to facilitate operations for various embodiments described herein. In various embodiments, network I/O interface(s) **712** can be configured as one or more Ethernet port(s), Fibre Channel ports, any other I/O port(s), and/or antenna(s)/antenna array(s) now known or hereafter developed. Thus, the network processor unit(s) **710** and/or network I/O interface(s) **712** may include suitable interfaces for receiving, transmitting, and/or otherwise communicating data and/or information in a network environment.

(76) I/O interface(s) **714** allow for input and output of data and/or information with other entities that may be connected to computing device **700**. For example, I/O interface(s) **714** may provide a connection to external devices such as a keyboard, keypad, a touch screen, and/or any other suitable input and/or output device now known or hereafter developed. In some instances, external devices can also include portable computer readable (non-transitory) storage media such as database systems, thumb drives, portable optical or magnetic disks, and memory cards. In still some instances, external devices can be a mechanism to display data to a user, such as, for

example, a computer monitor, a display screen, or the like.

(77) In various embodiments, control logic **720** can include instructions that, when executed, cause processor(s) **702** to perform operations, which can include, but not be limited to, providing overall control operations of computing device; interacting with other entities, systems, etc. described herein; maintaining and/or interacting with stored data, information, parameters, etc. (e.g., memory element(s), storage, data structures, databases, tables, etc.); combinations thereof; and/or the like to facilitate various operations for embodiments described herein.

(78) The programs described herein (e.g., control logic **720**) may be identified based upon application(s) for which they are implemented in a specific embodiment. However, it should be appreciated that any particular program nomenclature herein is used merely for convenience; thus, embodiments herein should not be limited to use(s) solely described in any specific application(s) identified and/or implied by such nomenclature.

(79) In various embodiments, any entity or apparatus as described herein may store data/information in any suitable volatile and/or non-volatile memory item (e.g., magnetic hard disk drive, solid state hard drive, semiconductor storage device, random access memory (RAM), read only memory (ROM), erasable programmable read only memory (EPROM), application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), etc.), software, logic (fixed logic, hardware logic, programmable logic, analog logic, digital logic), hardware, and/or in any other suitable component, device, element, and/or object as may be appropriate. Any of the memory items discussed herein should be construed as being encompassed within the broad term 'memory element'. Data/information being tracked and/or sent to one or more entities as discussed herein could be provided in any database, table, register, list, cache, storage, and/or storage structure: all of which can be referenced at any suitable timeframe. Any such storage options may also be included within the broad term 'memory element' as used herein.

(80) Note that in certain example implementations, operations as set forth herein may be implemented by logic encoded in one or more tangible media that is capable of storing instructions and/or digital information and may be inclusive of non-transitory tangible media and/or non-transitory computer readable storage media (e.g., embedded logic provided in: an ASIC, digital signal processing (DSP) instructions, software [potentially inclusive of object code and source code], etc.) for execution by one or more processor(s), and/or other similar machine, etc. Generally, memory element(s) **704** and/or storage **706** can store data, software, code, instructions (e.g., processor instructions), logic, parameters, combinations thereof, and/or the like used for operations described herein. This includes memory element(s) **704** and/or storage **706** being able to store data, software, code, instructions (e.g., processor instructions), logic, parameters, combinations thereof, or the like that are executed to carry out operations in accordance with teachings of the present disclosure.

(81) In some instances, software of the present embodiments may be available via a non-transitory computer useable medium (e.g., magnetic or optical mediums, magneto-optic mediums, CD-ROM, DVD, memory devices, etc.) of a stationary or portable program product apparatus, downloadable file(s), file wrapper(s), object(s), package(s), container(s), and/or the like. In some instances, non-transitory computer readable storage media may also be removable. For example, a removable hard drive may be used for memory/storage in some implementations. Other examples may include optical and magnetic disks, thumb drives, and smart cards that can be inserted and/or otherwise connected to a computing device for transfer onto another computer readable storage medium.

(82) In one form, a computer-implemented method is provided that may include: receiving, by a Connectivity Management Platform (CMP), a request for a secure device onboarding (SDO) access token from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the request includes an identifier for a user, an identifier for a customer organization, and an authorization code; verifying the authorization code via an authorization server; upon verifying the authorization code, querying, by the CMP, an enterprise server using the identifier for the user and the identifier for the customer

organization to confirm whether the user belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the user belongs to the customer organization: generating, by the CMP, the SDO access token; storing the SDO access token in an authentication datastore of the CMP; and transmitting, by the CMP, the SDO access token to the DMP for use in one or more device transactions.

(83) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: prior to receiving the request for the SDO access token that includes the authorization code, receiving by the CMP an initial request for the SDO access token from the DMP that does not include the authorization code; and redirecting the DMP to the authorization server to obtain the authorization code, wherein the authorization code is obtained based on an authorization process involving credentials for the user.

(84) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein during the authorization process, the DMP sends the credentials for the user to the authorization server, and the authorization server returns the authorization code to the DMP in response to verifying the credentials for the user.

(85) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein verifying the authorization code further includes: transmitting, by the CMP, a request to the authorization server to verify the authorization code that is included in the request for the SDO access token; and receiving, by the CMP, a response from the authorization server indicating whether the authorization code is verified.

(86) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein determining that the user belongs to the customer organization includes: receiving, via a customer resolution service of the CMP, a user status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the user associated therewith in an account management database of the enterprise server.

(87) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein generating the SDO access token includes: creating, via an identity service of the CMP, the SDO access token to be specific to the user and to the customer organization.

(88) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: receiving, by the CMP, a device provisioning request from the DMP, wherein the device provisioning request includes an identifier for an eSIM of a device and the SDO access token; verifying the SDO access token via the authentication datastore of the CMP; upon verifying the SDO access token, obtaining, by the CMP, the identifier for the customer organization based on the SDO access token from the authentication datastore of the CMP; querying, by the CMP, the enterprise server using the identifier for the eSIM of the device and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the device belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the device belongs to the customer organization, facilitating, by the CMP, secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.

(89) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein verifying the SDO access token includes: confirming, via a provisioning service of the CMP, that the SDO access token included in the device provisioning request is stored in the authentication datastore of the CMP.

(90) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein obtaining the identifier for the customer organization by the CMP includes: retrieving, via the provisioning service of the CMP, the identifier for the customer organization that is associated with the SDO access token in the authentication datastore.

(91) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein determining that the device belongs to the customer organization includes: receiving, via an eSIM ownership service of the CMP, a device status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the eSIM of the

device associated therewith in an eSIM inventory database of the enterprise server.

(92) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: transmitting, via a provisioning service of the CMP, a message to the DMP indicating that secure provisioning of the device with the eSIM profile has been completed successfully in response to the device provisioning request.

(93) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an apparatus including: one or more memories configured to store computer readable instructions; and one or more processors configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: receive a request for a secure device onboarding (SDO) access token from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the request includes an identifier for a user, an identifier for a customer organization, and an authorization code; verify the authorization code via an authorization server; upon verifying the authorization code, query an enterprise server using the identifier for the user and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the user belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the user belongs to the customer organization: generate the SDO access token; store the SDO access token in an authentication datastore; and transmit the SDO access token to the DMP for use in one or more device transactions.

(94) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an apparatus, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: receive, via a customer resolution service, a user status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the user associated therewith in an account management database of the enterprise server.

(95) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an apparatus, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: create, via an identity service, the SDO access token to be specific to the user and to the customer organization.

(96) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an apparatus, wherein the one or more processors are further configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: receive a device provisioning request from the DMP, wherein the device provisioning request includes an identifier for an eSIM of a device and the SDO access token; verify the SDO access token via the authentication datastore; upon verifying the SDO access token, obtain the identifier for the customer organization based on the SDO access token from the authentication datastore; query the enterprise server using the identifier for the eSIM of the device and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the device belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the device belongs to the customer organization, facilitate secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.

(97) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an apparatus, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: confirm, via a provisioning service, that the SDO access token included in the device provisioning request is stored in the authentication datastore.

(98) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an apparatus, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: retrieve, via the provisioning service, the identifier for the customer organization that is associated with the SDO access token in the authentication datastore.

(99) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an apparatus, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: receive, via an eSIM ownership service, a device status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the eSIM of the device associated therewith in an eSIM inventory database of the enterprise server.

(100) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to one or more non-transitory computer readable storage media storing a program of instructions, which when executed by a processor, configure the processor to perform operations including: receiving a request for a secure

device onboarding (SDO) access token from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the request includes an identifier for a user, an identifier for a customer organization, and an authorization code; verifying the authorization code via an authorization server; upon verifying the authorization code, querying an enterprise server using the identifier for the user and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the user belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the user belongs to the customer organization: generating the SDO access token; storing the SDO access token in an authentication datastore; and transmitting the SDO access token to the DMP for use in one or more device transactions.

(101) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to one or more non-transitory computer readable storage media, wherein the program of instructions when executed by the processor perform further operations including: receiving a device provisioning request from the DMP, wherein the device provisioning request includes an identifier for an eSIM of a device and the SDO access token; verifying the SDO access token via the authentication datastore; upon verifying the SDO access token, obtaining the identifier for the customer organization based on the SDO access token from the authentication datastore; querying the enterprise server using the identifier for the eSIM of the device and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the device belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the device belongs to the customer organization, facilitating secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.

(102) In another form, a computer-implemented method is provided that may include: receiving, by a Connectivity Management Platform (CMP), a device provisioning request from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the device provisioning request includes an identifier for an eSIM of a device and a secure device onboarding (SDO) access token; verifying the SDO access token via an authentication datastore of the CMP; upon verifying the SDO access token, obtaining, by the CMP, an identifier for a customer organization based on the SDO access token from the authentication datastore of the CMP; querying, by the CMP, an enterprise server using the identifier for the eSIM of the device and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the device belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the device belongs to the customer organization, facilitating, by the CMP, secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.

(103) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein verifying the SDO access token includes: confirming, via a provisioning service of the CMP, that the SDO access token included in the device provisioning request is stored in the authentication datastore of the CMP.

(104) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein obtaining the identifier for the customer organization by the CMP includes: retrieving, via the provisioning service of the CMP, the identifier of the customer organization that is associated with the SDO access token in the authentication datastore; or deriving, via the provisioning service of the CMP, the identifier of the customer organization based on the SDO access token.

(105) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein determining that the device belongs to the customer organization includes: receiving, via an eSIM ownership service of the CMP, a device status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the eSIM of the device associated therewith in an eSIM inventory database of the enterprise server.

(106) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: transmitting, via a provisioning service of the CMP, a message to the DMP indicating that secure provisioning of the device with the eSIM profile has been completed successfully in response to the device provisioning request.

(107) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: receiving, by the CMP, a request for the SDO access token from the DMP, wherein the request

includes an identifier for a user, the identifier for the customer organization, and an authorization code; verifying the authorization code via an authorization server; upon verifying the authorization code, querying, by the CMP, the enterprise server using the identifier for the user and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the user belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the user belongs to the customer organization: generating, by the CMP, the SDO access token; storing the SDO access token in the authentication datastore of the CMP; and transmitting, by the CMP, the SDO access token to the DMP for use in the device provisioning request.

(108) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein determining that the user belongs to the customer organization includes: receiving, via a customer resolution service of the CMP, a user status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the user associated therewith in an account management database of the enterprise server.

(109) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein generating the SDO access token includes: creating, via an identity service of the CMP, the SDO access token to be specific to the user and to the customer organization.

(110) Note that in this Specification, references to various features (e.g., elements, structures, nodes, modules, components, engines, logic, steps, operations, functions, characteristics, etc.) included in ‘one embodiment’, ‘example embodiment’, ‘an embodiment’, ‘another embodiment’, ‘certain embodiments’, ‘some embodiments’, ‘various embodiments’, ‘other embodiments’, ‘alternative embodiment’, and the like are intended to mean that any such features are included in one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, but may or may not necessarily be combined in the same embodiments. Note also that a module, engine, client, controller, function, logic or the like as used herein in this Specification, can be inclusive of an executable file comprising instructions that can be understood and processed on a server, computer, processor, machine, compute node, combinations thereof, or the like and may further include library modules loaded during execution, object files, system files, hardware logic, software logic, or any other executable modules.

(111) It is also noted that the operations and steps described with reference to the preceding figures illustrate only some of the possible scenarios that may be executed by one or more entities discussed herein. Some of these operations may be deleted or removed where appropriate, or these steps may be modified or changed considerably without departing from the scope of the presented concepts. In addition, the timing and sequence of these operations may be altered considerably and still achieve the results taught in this disclosure. The preceding operational flows have been offered for purposes of example and discussion. Substantial flexibility is provided by the embodiments in that any suitable arrangements, chronologies, configurations, and timing mechanisms may be provided without departing from the teachings of the discussed concepts.

(112) As used herein, unless expressly stated to the contrary, use of the phrase ‘at least one of’, ‘one or more of’, ‘and/or’, variations thereof, or the like are open-ended expressions that are both conjunctive and disjunctive in operation for any and all possible combination of the associated listed items. For example, each of the expressions ‘at least one of X, Y and Z’, ‘at least one of X, Y or Z’, ‘one or more of X, Y and Z’, ‘one or more of X, Y or Z’ and ‘X, Y and/or Z’ can mean any of the following: 1) X, but not Y and not Z; 2) Y, but not X and not Z; 3) Z, but not X and not Y; 4) X and Y, but not Z; 5) X and Z, but not Y; 6) Y and Z, but not X; or 7) X, Y, and Z.

(113) Each example embodiment disclosed herein has been included to present one or more different features. However, all disclosed example embodiments are designed to work together as part of a single larger system or method. This disclosure explicitly envisions compound embodiments that combine multiple previously-discussed features in different example embodiments into a single system or method.

(114) Additionally, unless expressly stated to the contrary, the terms ‘first’, ‘second’, ‘third’, etc.,

are intended to distinguish the particular nouns they modify (e.g., element, condition, node, module, activity, operation, etc.). Unless expressly stated to the contrary, the use of these terms is not intended to indicate any type of order, rank, importance, temporal sequence, or hierarchy of the modified noun. For example, 'first X' and 'second X' are intended to designate two 'X' elements that are not necessarily limited by any order, rank, importance, temporal sequence, or hierarchy of the two elements. Further as referred to herein, 'at least one of' and 'one or more of' can be represented using the '(s)' nomenclature (e.g., one or more element(s)).

(115) One or more advantages described herein are not meant to suggest that any one of the embodiments described herein necessarily provides all of the described advantages or that all the embodiments of the present disclosure necessarily provide any one of the described advantages. Numerous other changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and/or modifications may be ascertained to one skilled in the art and it is intended that the present disclosure encompass all such changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and/or modifications as falling within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A method comprising: receiving, by a Connectivity Management Platform (CMP), a request for a secure device onboarding (SDO) access token from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the request includes an identifier for a user, an identifier for a customer organization, and an authorization code; verifying the authorization code via an authorization server; upon verifying the authorization code, querying, by the CMP, an enterprise server using the identifier for the user and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the user belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the user belongs to the customer organization: generating, by the CMP, the SDO access token; storing the SDO access token in an authentication datastore of the CMP; and transmitting, by the CMP, the SDO access token to the DMP for use in one or more device transactions.
2. The method of claim 1, further comprising: prior to receiving the request for the SDO access token that includes the authorization code, receiving by the CMP an initial request for the SDO access token from the DMP that does not include the authorization code; and redirecting the DMP to the authorization server to obtain the authorization code, wherein the authorization code is obtained based on an authorization process involving credentials for the user.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein during the authorization process, the DMP sends the credentials for the user to the authorization server, and the authorization server returns the authorization code to the DMP in response to verifying the credentials for the user.
4. The method of claim 2, wherein verifying the authorization code further comprises: transmitting, by the CMP, a request to the authorization server to verify the authorization code that is included in the request for the SDO access token; and receiving, by the CMP, a response from the authorization server indicating whether the authorization code is verified.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein determining that the user belongs to the customer organization comprises: receiving, via a customer resolution service of the CMP, a user status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the user associated therewith in an account management database of the enterprise server.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein generating the SDO access token comprises: creating, via an identity service of the CMP, the SDO access token to be specific to the user and to the customer organization.
7. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, by the CMP, a device provisioning request from the DMP, wherein the device provisioning request includes an identifier for an eSIM of a device and the SDO access token; verifying the SDO access token via the authentication datastore

of the CMP; upon verifying the SDO access token, obtaining, by the CMP, the identifier for the customer organization based on the SDO access token from the authentication datastore of the CMP; querying, by the CMP, the enterprise server using the identifier for the eSIM of the device and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the device belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the device belongs to the customer organization, facilitating, by the CMP, secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.

8. The method of claim 7, wherein verifying the SDO access token comprises: confirming, via a provisioning service of the CMP, that the SDO access token included in the device provisioning request is stored in the authentication datastore of the CMP.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein obtaining the identifier for the customer organization by the CMP comprises: retrieving, via the provisioning service of the CMP, the identifier for the customer organization that is associated with the SDO access token in the authentication datastore.

10. The method of claim 7, wherein determining that the device belongs to the customer organization comprises: receiving, via an eSIM ownership service of the CMP, a device status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the eSIM of the device associated therewith in an eSIM inventory database of the enterprise server.

11. The method of claim 7, further comprising: transmitting, via a provisioning service of the CMP, a message to the DMP indicating that secure provisioning of the device with the eSIM profile has been completed successfully in response to the device provisioning request.

12. An apparatus comprising: one or more memories configured to store computer readable instructions; and one or more processors configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: receive a request for a secure device onboarding (SDO) access token from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the request includes an identifier for a user, an identifier for a customer organization, and an authorization code; verify the authorization code via an authorization server; upon verifying the authorization code, query an enterprise server using the identifier for the user and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the user belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the user belongs to the customer organization: generate the SDO access token; store the SDO access token in an authentication datastore; and transmit the SDO access token to the DMP for use in one or more device transactions.

13. The apparatus of claim 12, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: receive, via a customer resolution service, a user status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the user associated therewith in an account management database of the enterprise server.

14. The apparatus of claim 12, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: create, via an identity service, the SDO access token to be specific to the user and to the customer organization.

15. The apparatus of claim 12, wherein the one or more processors are further configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: receive a device provisioning request from the DMP, wherein the device provisioning request includes an identifier for an eSIM of a device and the SDO access token; verify the SDO access token via the authentication datastore; upon verifying the SDO access token, obtain the identifier for the customer organization based on the SDO access token from the authentication datastore; query the enterprise server using the identifier for the eSIM of the device and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the device belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the device belongs to the customer organization, facilitate secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.

16. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: confirm, via a provisioning service, that the SDO access token

included in the device provisioning request is stored in the authentication datastore.

17. The apparatus of claim 16, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: retrieve, via the provisioning service, the identifier for the customer organization that is associated with the SDO access token in the authentication datastore.

18. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute the computer readable instructions to: receive, via an eSIM ownership service, a device status from the enterprise server in response to the enterprise server determining that the identifier for the customer organization has the identifier for the eSIM of the device associated therewith in an eSIM inventory database of the enterprise server.

19. One or more non-transitory computer readable storage media storing a program of instructions, which when executed by a processor, configure the processor to perform operations comprising: receiving a request for a secure device onboarding (SDO) access token from a Device Management Platform (DMP), wherein the request includes an identifier for a user, an identifier for a customer organization, and an authorization code; verifying the authorization code via an authorization server; upon verifying the authorization code, querying an enterprise server using the identifier for the user and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the user belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the user belongs to the customer organization: generating the SDO access token; storing the SDO access token in an authentication datastore; and transmitting the SDO access token to the DMP for use in one or more device transactions.

20. The one or more non-transitory computer readable storage media of claim 19, wherein the program of instructions when executed by the processor perform further operations comprising: receiving a device provisioning request from the DMP, wherein the device provisioning request includes an identifier for an eSIM of a device and the SDO access token; verifying the SDO access token via the authentication datastore; upon verifying the SDO access token, obtaining the identifier for the customer organization based on the SDO access token from the authentication datastore; querying the enterprise server using the identifier for the eSIM of the device and the identifier for the customer organization to confirm whether the device belongs to the customer organization; and based on determining that the device belongs to the customer organization, facilitating secure provisioning of the device with an eSIM profile.
